PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

OFFICIAL PAPER BOUNDARY → SECTION-CHOICE CONSTRAINT → PAPER-LAYOUT CAUTIONS → OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC → PROMPT VIABILITY GATE → FAMILIARITY TEST

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ★ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 OFFICIAL PAPER BOUNDARY

OFFICIAL PAPER BOUNDARY · 2024 PAPER · CLEAN TWO-ESSAY AND ONE-PER-SECTION INSTRUCTION · 2025 PAPER · GARBLED ENGLISH LINE BUT TWO SECTIONS REMAIN CLEAR · THREE-HOUR DURATION · AUDITED FACT IS NOT A PREDICTION OF A FUTURE

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
2024 PAPER → clean two-essay and one-per-section instruction	SCHEME → three-hour duration	2024 PAPER → clean two-essay and one-per-section instruction
2025 PAPER → garbled English line but two sections remain clear	FIREWALL → audited fact is not a prediction of a future paper	2025 PAPER → garbled English line but two sections remain clear

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- 2024 PAPER → clean two-essay and one-per-section instruction
- 2025 PAPER → garbled English line but two sections remain clear

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- SCHEME → three-hour duration
- FIREWALL → audited fact is not a prediction of a future paper

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- 2024 PAPER → clean two-essay and one-per-section instruction
- 2025 PAPER → garbled English line but two sections remain clear

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FIREWALL → audited fact is not a prediction of a future paper.

01

STAGE 01 SECTION-CHOICE CONSTRAINT

SECTION-CHOICE CONSTRAINT · SECTION A · SCAN FOUR PROMPTS · CHOOSE ONE · SECTION B · TWO ESSAYS · BOTH CHOICES FROM THE SAME SECTION

SECTION A → scan four prompts → choose one → SECTION B → scan four prompts → choose one → PAIR → two essays → INVALID → both choices from the same Section

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- SECTION A → scan four prompts → choose one
- SECTION B → scan four prompts → choose one

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- PAIR → two essays
- INVALID → both choices from the same Section

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- SECTION A → scan four prompts → choose one
- SECTION B → scan four prompts → choose one

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INVALID → both choices from the same Section.

02

STAGE 02 PAPER-LAYOUT CAUTIONS

PAPER-LAYOUT CAUTIONS · HINDI THEN ENGLISH · 2024 B NUMBERING · 2025 B NUMBERING · READ HEADINGS BEFORE RELYING ON NUMBERS

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
BILINGUAL → Hindi then English	2025 B NUMBERING → continues	BILINGUAL → Hindi then English
2024 B NUMBERING → restarts	ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers	2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- BILINGUAL → Hindi then English
- 2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- 2025 B NUMBERING → continues
- ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- BILINGUAL → Hindi then English
- 2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers.

03

STAGE 03 OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC

OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC · ATTEMPT STRUCTURE AND AUDITED WORDING · SCAN, SCORE, ALLOCATE AND COMMIT · NOT PRINTED · GRANULAR RUBRIC OR PARAGRAPH COUNT · NEVER PROMOTE A HEURISTIC INTO AN INSTRUCTION

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording
- STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- NOT PRINTED → granular rubric or paragraph count
- RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording
- STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction.

04

STAGE 04 PROMPT VIABILITY GATE

PROMPT VIABILITY GATE · RESTATABLE CLAIM? · QUALIFIED THESIS? · DISTINCT DIMENSIONS? · SAFE EVIDENCE? · IF ANY ANSWER IS NO, RAISE RISK

RESTATABLE CLAIM? → QUALIFIED THESIS? → DISTINCT DIMENSIONS? → SAFE EVIDENCE? → if any answer is no, raise risk

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- RESTATABLE CLAIM?
- QUALIFIED THESIS?

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- DISTINCT DIMENSIONS?
- SAFE EVIDENCE? → if any answer is no, raise risk

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- RESTATABLE CLAIM?
- QUALIFIED THESIS?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE EVIDENCE? → if any answer is no, raise risk.

05

STAGE 05 FAMILIARITY TEST

FAMILIARITY TEST · FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT · FAMILIAR + FACT STACK · UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION · POTENTIALLY SAFER · TRACTABILITY OUTRANKS COMFORT

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable	UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer	FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable
FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe	DECISION → tractability outranks comfort	FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable
- FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer
- DECISION → tractability outranks comfort

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable
- FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer; DECISION → tractability outranks comfort.

06

STAGE 06 ORIGINALITY BOUNDARY

ORIGINALITY BOUNDARY · PLAIN READING · FAITHFUL BUT CONTESTABLE · ORIGINAL MOVE · QUALIFIED CONNECTION OR SYNTHESIS · ECCENTRIC MOVE · LOSES THE PRINTED RELATION · ORIGINALITY THAT REMAINS TEXT-BOUND

PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable

ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis → ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation → KEEP → originality that remains text-bound

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable
- ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation
- KEEP → originality that remains text-bound

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable
- ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation; KEEP → originality that remains text-bound.

07

STAGE 07 EVIDENCE-RISK SCREEN

EVIDENCE-RISK SCREEN · NAMED AND SAFELY RECALLABLE ILLUSTRATION · USEFUL BUT DETAIL UNCERTAIN · INVENTED NUMBER, AUTHOR OR FORCED EXAMPLE · PREFER THE PROMPT WITH STRONGER EVIDENCE SAFETY

GREEN → named and safely recallable illustration

AMBER → useful but detail uncertain → RED → invented number, author or forced example → CHOICE → prefer the prompt with stronger evidence safety

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- GREEN → named and safely recallable illustration
- AMBER → useful but detail uncertain

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- RED → invented number, author or forced example
- CHOICE → prefer the prompt with stronger evidence safety

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- GREEN → named and safely recallable illustration
- AMBER → useful but detail uncertain

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHOICE → prefer the prompt with stronger evidence safety.

08

STAGE 08 CONCLUSION FEASIBILITY

CONCLUSION FEASIBILITY · EARNED SYNTHESIS · FORCED ENDING · WARNING THAT CHOICE MAY BE WEAK

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- THESIS → DIMENSIONS → COUNTER-VIEW
- COUNTER-VIEW → QUALIFICATION

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- QUALIFICATION → EARNED SYNTHESIS
- FORCED ENDING → warning that choice may be weak

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- THESIS → DIMENSIONS → COUNTER-VIEW
- COUNTER-VIEW → QUALIFICATION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FORCED ENDING → warning that choice may be weak.

09

STAGE 09 TWO-ESSAY PORTFOLIO

TWO-ESSAY PORTFOLIO · ESSAY A · CLARITY + DEPTH + EVIDENCE · ESSAY B · SHARED BUDGET · PLANNING + DRAFTING + REVISION · PAIR TEST · NEITHER CHOICE SHOULD IMPOVERISH THE OTHER

ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence

ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence → SHARED BUDGET → planning + drafting + revision → PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence
- ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- SHARED BUDGET → planning + drafting + revision
- PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence
- ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other.

10

STAGE 10 COMMITMENT RULE

COMMITMENT RULE · BOUNDED SCAN · VIABILITY PASSED · EARLY FAILURE · SWITCH ONCE BEFORE DRAFTING EXPANDS · LATE DOUBT · RETURN TO THESIS AND EVIDENCE MAP · DO NOT CHASE A FASHIONABLE ALTERNATIVE

BOUNDED SCAN → viability passed → commit

EARLY FAILURE → switch once before drafting expands → LATE DOUBT → return to thesis and evidence map → DISCIPLINE → do not chase a fashionable alternative

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- BOUNDED SCAN → viability passed → commit
- EARLY FAILURE → switch once before drafting expands

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- LATE DOUBT → return to thesis and evidence map
- DISCIPLINE → do not chase a fashionable alternative

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- BOUNDED SCAN → viability passed → commit
- EARLY FAILURE → switch once before drafting expands

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → do not chase a fashionable alternative.

11

STAGE 11 SELECTION ANSWER SPINE

SELECTION ANSWER SPINE · READ RULE · SCAN EACH SECTION · CLASSIFY PROMPTS · TEST THESIS · TEST DIMENSIONS · TEST EVIDENCE · SCREEN RISK

READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS → TEST THESIS → TEST DIMENSIONS → TEST EVIDENCE → SCREEN RISK → TEST THE PAIR → ALLOCATE TIME → COMMIT → DECODE OR SCOPE → PLAN

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS
- TEST THESIS → TEST DIMENSIONS → TEST EVIDENCE

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- SCREEN RISK → TEST THE PAIR → ALLOCATE TIME
- COMMIT → DECODE OR SCOPE → PLAN

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS
- TEST THESIS → TEST DIMENSIONS → TEST EVIDENCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · APHORISM PROMPTS (MOST OF BOTH YEARS' SECTIONS) · ISSUE-STATEMENT PROMPTS (E.G. 2024-B5 ON SOCIAL MEDIA/FOMO) · HIGH-FIT PROMPT · THESIS EMERGES WITHIN ABOUT A MINUTE, ≥2 REAL · LOW-FIT PROMPT · ANY OF THE ABOVE MISSING, OR ONLY RECOVERABLE · INTEREST VS. TRACTABILITY

OPTIONAL INTERPRETIVE / DIALECTICAL DEPTH
- Aphorism prompts (most of both years' Sections): compressed,
- Issue-statement prompts (e.g. 2024-B5 on social media/FOMO): more
- High-fit prompt: thesis emerges within about a minute, ≥2 real
- Low-fit prompt: any of the above missing, or only recoverable

PROMPT, ATTRIBUTION OR OFFICIAL-RULE LIMIT
- Interest vs. tractability: the assumption that liking a subject
- Familiarity vs. depth: a "familiar" topic invites GS-answer
- Speed vs. reversibility: choice happens early and is costly to
- NOT: Sunk-cost persistence: continuing with a poorly-fitting prompt

COMPARATIVE ARGUMENT / STRUCTURE NUANCE
- NOT: Over-deliberation: spending disproportionate time optimising
- NOT: Choosing purely to avoid a weaker Section , ignoring that both
- Subject: Essay | Tier: Advanced | GS Paper: Essay (General Studies Paper — Essay, Mains).
- Core area: Choice as a portfolio/risk decision

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels